

75 TRICKS
with a
STRIPPER DECK

Compiled and Edited by
AL STEVENSON

2nd Edition * Completely Revised
WIZARD BOOKS
22 - 14 FORTIETH AVENUE
LONG-ISLAND CITY 1
NEW YORK

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TO
my friends of THE WIZARD'S SHOP
who have bought the Wizard Deck and are anxious
to do other than the elementary effects
given in the instructions.

PREFACE TO SECOND EDITION

The first edition of this booklet was published in 1957 and has been out of print for some time.

Several friends, including magic dealers, have urged me to re-print it. However, I felt that the original version had room for improvement and so I have revised the entire manuscript, discarding some effects and adding others.

It is my hope that my efforts will give many hours of pleasure to those who like to do card tricks but have neither the time nor the patience required to practice intricate sleights of hand. But: Don't sell the stripper short! Once you learn to handle it well, you may find the necessary time and patience and -combined with sleights of hand- a stripper deck will make it possible for you to do apparent miracles.

ALWYN STENSON

New York, 1962

INTRODUCTION

In the opinion of the author, one of the most neglected pieces of magical apparatus is the tapered, or "stripper," deck. Properly used, this deck can give

the impression of miraculous sleight of hand and -even more important- properly handled, the stripper cannot be spotted as being gimmicked.

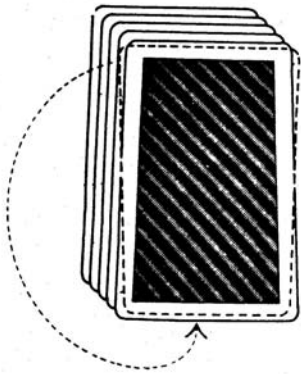
The principle of the stripper is not as commonly known as most magicians believe despite the fact that the tapered deck is many years old. It has been said many times that to use the stripper is "cheating," but the stripper can be placed in the same category as the short card, forcing deck, etc. Gimmicked cards and even entire trick decks have been used by many card men. But it is the end result, the making of a Mystery, that counts. The means used to attain that end are unimportant.

This manuscript has been written with the express Purpose of making those who shun the stripper, or who are not aware of it's possibilities, come to the realization of the fact that as an adjunct to sleight of hand, or by itself, if need be, the proper use of the stripper can get them the approbation and applause of their audiences whenever they perform.

The stripper deck has many uses other than the location of a card or group of cards and the following pages will prove to you that, with it, you can do undreamed of things in card magic, create effects impossible with sleight of hand. Turn to any page in this book, read any one of the numerous effects, and give yourself a pleasant surprise. The tapered deck is a magical "tool"-and the proper use of this tool is the Purpose of this book.

THE TAPERED DECK

The principle of the tapered deck is a simple one: One end of the deck is narrower than the other. Consequently, with all the cards one way and one card reversed in the deck, the reversed card is easily located as then the wide end of the card is at the narrow end of the deck and it protrudes.



A crudely cut deck is not practical. The taper should be slight and so gradual that even the performer should have to look closely to notice it. You may, however, use a crudely cut deck to initiate you into the mysteries of the stripper, then use a finer cut when you have become proficient. Your success with the stripper depends wholly upon your handling of the pack, a naturalness in working with it. You must be able to strip cards from the pack easily and swiftly, yet do it as if you were handling nothing more than an ordinary pack of cards.

Do not run your fingers along the edge of the deck to detect reversed cards; just lightly touch the sides of the deck at both ends. Your hands are under constant scrutiny. Fumbling the edges of the deck is a sure giveaway; it is an unnatural movement and will arouse suspicion.

When a card has been selected the deck must be reversed, but the reversal should not be obvious. Fanning the deck and closing it is the most practical way of reversing the deck. Hold the deck face down in your left hand, thumb on top, fingers beneath. The right forefinger hits the top left hand edge of the pack, moves from left to right, spreading the cards into a fan. A card is selected, right forefinger closes the fan from left to right reversing the deck.



To REVERSE: Spread left to right, close left to right.

The selected card is replaced in the deck and can be stripped when desired.

Note: In the pages that follow, the term "reversed" will be used to designate the turning of a card (or the deck) end for end.

To become proficient with the stripper it is most important that you develop ease in the handling of the deck. Practice, opening and closing fans of cards, and stripping one or more cards that have been reversed in the deck.

Handle the deck lightly. You do not need supersensitive fingers to handle this deck. It is easier to locate a reversed card by using a light touch rather than squeezing the sides of the deck. If stripping a reversed card from the deck seems obvious to you at first, strip the card or cards not of the deck with the deck behind your back. This will, in fact, add to the mystery insofar as the spectator is concerned.

Eventually you will attain the ability to strip not one or more cards in full view of the spectator and place them on top or bottom of the deck without it being noticeable.

Make it a habit to look directly at the spectator when stripping a card. In the second he returns your look you can have the card out and on top of the deck.

A little story with each effect is also desirable for patter is in itself misdirection. Pick out, a half dozen of the effects in this book, try them on someone. You will not only surprise them, you will surprise yourself.

#1
THE COINCIDENCE

Have a card selected and (without allowing its face to be seen) initialed on the back by a spectator. Reverse the deck and have the card inserted. Shuffle and lay deck face down on the table. Cut to reversed card, have this packet turned face up and ask the spectator to mark the face-up card. He is, of course, unaware that it is the same one he previously initialed on the back. Shuffle again. Locate the marked card in any way you wish, then show the amazing coincidence of the spectator marking the same card twice.

#2
THE PERFECT COUNT

Reverse the twenty sixth card in the pack. Remark to the spectators that you have, through years of experience, developed the ability to judge the amount of cards in any packet by its thickness. Cut the deck at the reversed card and hand the packet you have removed to a spectator telling him that you have judged exactly half the pack.

#3
THE SHUFFLED SETUP

Many effects are possible with a pre-arranged deck. Naturally, you cannot offer a set-up deck for shuffling. However, if you have a stripper set up in a certain order simply reverse half the pack and place it in the card case. When ready to perform, remove the pack from the case and hand it to the spectator for one riffle shuffle, then take the deck and strip out the reversed cards. You will now have the set-up in two packets. Place the two packets together in their proper order and the deck is again set up in the original pre-arranged order.

#4
MIXED UP MIRACLE

Divide the deck into two equal piles, reverse one pile and place the two piles face to face. Now, thoroughly shuffle the deck. Place the deck behind your back, strip the entire deck, turn one half over and place it upon the other half, then bring the deck forward. Ribbon-spread the cards and show they are all one way.

#5

ODDS AND EVENS

Beforehand have the deck separated into two piles, one pile all the odd numbers, the other pile, all even numbers. Reverse one pile and shuffle in the normal manner. After shuffling, strip the entire deck behind your back and show you have separated odd numbers from even numbers.

#6

A SIMPLE FORCE

Have the card you want to force reversed on the bottom of the pack. Shuffle, place the deck face down on the table and casually cut to the reversed card. Show it to the spectator. Do not give the impression you are cutting to a certain card, cut the deck casually.

#7

THE POKER HAND

Have a straight flush reversed in the deck. Shuffle and strip the flush to the top. Deal out five poker hands around the table (five cards each). Pick up each hand, show it briefly, do not disturb its order, and place each hand back on top of the deck. Deal out five hands again of five cards each, then show that you have dealt yourself a straight flush. Unknown to the spectator every fifth card on top of the deck is part of the flush.

#8

READING THE DECK

Memorize five cards and reverse them in the deck. Tell the spectator that you can read the backs of the cards. Shuffle and strip the five memorized cards to the top of the deck. Remove the top card face down, call not the name of one of the five you have memorized, and place it face down on the table. Repeat this until you have the five top cards face down on the table. Mix them up, then turn them over and show you have called the five cards correctly.

#9

COLOR SEPARATION

This is a real eye popper. Before starting your performance, separate the reds and blacks and reverse one color. To begin, shuffle the entire deck and display the faces of the cards showing them to be thoroughly mixed. Fan the deck with the backs toward you and have a red card selected. Ask the spectator to remember his card. Reverse the deck and have the card replaced. Fan again and have a black card selected. Reverse and replace.

Now, shuffle thoroughly. Put the deck behind your back and completely strip out the entire deck. Bring it forward holding the two packets and show

that you have not only completely separated reds from blacks but the red selected card is among the black, and the black selected card! among the red.

#10

THE INDIAN GIVER

Break the deck into two piles. Give one to a spectator, reversing his pile as you hand it to him. Ask him to look at any card in his pile and insert it face down into your pile. Shuffle your pile, strip out the card he gave you and place it face down in his pile. Ask him to name his card. Show it is not in your pile as he thought. Tell him he is an "Indian Giver" and influenced you into giving him back the same card he gave you.

#11

AN ODDITY

Separate the red from the black cards into two piles. Reverse one pile and then make a single pile by alternating red and black. Hold the deck with both hands by the edges and strip the entire deck just the slightest fraction. If you now riffle the cards in one direction, you will see only red cards; riffle in the other direction and you will see only black cards.

#12

THE SMART SMELLER

Lay seven cards in a row on the table, the middle card reversed. Have a spectator write the aromas you call out, one each, on the backs of the cards, left to right. Turn your back if you wish. Call out, Rose, Violet, Jasmine, Lillies, Pine, Hemlock, Cedar. The reversed card will be Lillies, the fourth card called. Have the cards mixed and handed to you; strip Lillies to top. Smell each card, face toward you, remarking that you will find your favorite aroma: Lillies. You may do this with drinks or spices.

#13

POCKET LOCATION

The selected card is reversed in the deck and the deck is shuffled. Drop the deck into a spectator's shirt pocket. The end of the deck from which the reversed card protrudes should be up, that is: nearest to the edge of the pocket. Turn your head aside, reach into pocket with thumb and middle finger and remove selected card.

#14

POCKET PUZZLER

Have selected card reversed in the deck. Shuffle. Drop deck, protruding end of selected card uppermost, into spectator's shirt pocket. Ask for a number

between 1 and 20. Reach into spectator's pocket and remove and show cards one at a time. We will presume the number called was 14. Remove 13 cards from the top or the bottom of the deck; show the fourteenth (the reversed) card to be the one selected by spectator. Use thumb and middle finger when reaching into the spectator's pocket.

#15

A WEIRD REVERSAL

Take all the cards of one suit (spades, for example), reverse them, insert them in the deck, shuffle thoroughly and place the deck back in its case. When you are going to perform, remove the pack from your pocket and offer it to be shuffled. As the deck is being shuffled patter to the effect that thirteen is your lucky number and you are going to try an experiment with that number. Take the deck from the spectator and place it behind your back. Strip not the thirteen spades, turn them over and insert them together back into the pack. Bring the deck forward, face up; spread the deck and show that there are thirteen cards face down, together, a remarkable coincidence. Now, square the pack, men it face clown, spread the cards and-another coincidence has occurred: the thirteen cards are all spades!

#16

THE STABBED DECK

This is a remarkable effect and never fails to mystify. Have a card selected and inserted again in the reversed deck. Show an ordinary paper napkin. Wrap the deck in the napkin but, tested as you start to wrap, pull out the reversed card slightly - a quarter of an inch will do.

Hold the deck firmly as you wrap so that the protruding card does not slide back into the deck with the handling.

When the deck is wrapped, tuck under the ends of the napkin, again being careful not to move the protruding card. Hold the wrapped deck face up in your right hand and, with the left, push the tip of a knife blade into the napkin at the end of the deck where the card is partly stripped out. Push knife blade into the napkin from a slightly angled position, downward, so that the tip of the knife hits protruding card; then, level the knife and push it all the way in. The knife blade is now resting on the stripped card. Push the knife into the deck up to the handle, thereby pushing the stripped card back into the deck and even with the others. Ask that the selected card be named. Leave the knife in place and rip off the napkin showing the knife resting on the selected card. This is not an effect in be done hurriedly. Make a big thing of it and, when about to reveal that the knife is resting on the selected ease!, do it slowly.



#17
THE GAMBLER'S ACES

Have the four aces reversed in the deck. Tell those watching that you are going to prove that it is not smart to play cards with strangers. Shuffle the deck, place it face down on the table and cut to an ace. Do not show the ace but remove it from the packet and place it face down to one side. Do this three more times until you have cut and removed all of the aces. Turn over the four cards and show that you cut to an ace each time.

#18
THE THUMB COUNT

Remark that you have super sensitive fingers and can count cards while riffling them with your thumb. Beforehand, have the fifteenth card reversed in the deck. Be sure that you riffle the corner of the deck where the reversed card protrudes. Riffle this corner once or twice, break the deck at the reversed card and hand the packet to the spectator to be counted. You, of course, have stated in advance how many cards you are going to thumb count,

#19
OUT OF THE HAT

Selected card is stripped to top of deck, Borrow a felt hat, crease the top and hold hat high. Drop the deck into the hat, deck on one side of the crease, stripped card on the other. Snap the outside bottom of the hat, below stripped card. It will jump out of the hat.

#20
ALL CALL IT

Have a card reversed in the deck, King of Spades, for example. Shuffle, cut to the king and show it to one person present only. Reshuffle, do the same to another person. Do this four times, each time showing the same card but without letting any of the four spectators know that they have all looked at the King of Spades. Tell the four spectators to call out their card when you count to three. They will look and feel rather foolish when they all call out "King of Spades."

#21
THE FOUR ROBBERS

Remove the lone aces from the deck and lay them face down on the table. Reverse the deck and lay it on the table. Tell the story of four robbers intent upon robbing a house. Insert one ace low in the pack, face down; this robber is in the cellar. Another ace is inserted a bit higher in the pack, the first floor; a

third ace still higher in the pack, the second floor, and the last ace near the top of the pack. As you now shuffle the pack remark that one of the robbers looked out of the window and saw the police approaching. The only way of escape was through the roof. Strip the aces to the top, place the deck face down on the table and slowly remove the four top cards, one at a time. The four robbers are all on the roof.

#22

THE NEXT ONE IS IT

Have a card selected and replaced in the reversed deck. Hold the deck in your left hand, lightly feeling the selected card. Deal out one card at a time from the face-down pack, showing the card each time, and making a neat pile face down on the table. Continue dealing past the chosen card, then remark that the next card you show will be the selected card. Surprise them all by not showing the next card to be dealt but by cutting to the reversed card to be in the pile on the table.

#23

WITHOUT THE REVERSE

This will fool a magician. Have the entire lower half of the deck reversed. Ask someone to select a card from the *upper half* of the deck. Slowly riffle the cards so that the chosen card is inserted in the *lower* half of the deck. Break the deck at the center and give the top half to the spectator for shuffling. Shuffle the bottom half yourself. You can now strip out the selected card in your half.

#24

AN EYE POPPER

Have the deck in the case with all the red cards reversed. Remove the deck from the case and shuffle thoroughly. Strip the deck completely and put the two packets together. You now have a deck half red and half black. Hold the deck face down in your right hand, left thumb comes over to the top of the deck, left fingers underneath the deck. With your left hand, remove the top and bottom cards of the deck together, placing the two cards face down on the table. Continue doing this until the entire pack is on the table, face down. Turn the cards over, spread them, and show a perfect alternation of red and black throughout the deck.

#25

COIN-INCIDENCE

Reverse a deuce, trey, four and nine in your deck. Beforehand gather and

put in your trouser pocket a quantity of coins, all of different dates, but all dates totaling eighteen (1935, 1926, 1908, 1944, 1953, etc.). Cut deck at the four reversed cards, making four piles, with one of the reversed cards at the bottom of each pile, the four piles face down on the table. Casually remove the coins from your pocket and have one selected. Ask the spectator to total the four digits on his selected coin. When he announces the total (which must be eighteen), turn over each pile on the table and show that the four cards you cut to also total eighteen.

#26

THE PREDICTION

Before performing, reverse and note three cards in your deck. Tell your audience that you are feeling particularly clairvoyant and you would like them to help you in testing the validity of your feelings. Take a piece of paper and on it write the names of the three cards you have previously reversed in your stripper deck. Remarking that you have made a prediction, fold the paper and place it in a spectator's pocket. Shuffle your deck and place it in your, or another spectator's pocket. Tell your audience that you are going to remove cards, one at a time, from the pack and that anyone should call out "Now!" while your hand is still in the pocket. Proceed to take cards out as described placing them in a face-up pile to one side. Whenever someone calls "Now!" strip one of the reversed cards and put it face down on the other side of the table. Continue until you have stripped out the three cards you have "predicted." Ask the Spectator in whose pocket you have placed your prediction to read it aloud. Turn over the three cards you have placed singly and face down to one side of your table. Pick them up, one at a time, and call their names dramatically holding them up for all to see that your feelings did not deceive you.

NOTE: When placing the deck in the packet be sure that the end where the cards protrude is up.

#27

THE GIMMICKED CASE

In an old effect used with the stripper deck the card case is sandpapered thin at each side, near the bottom. When the deck, with the protruding card or cards down, is inserted into the case the fingers can feel these cards through the thin, sandpapered sides of the case. Hold the case open end down and allow all the cards except the reversed ones to fall out.

#28

THE FLIP OVER REVELATION

Bring reversed card to top. Push top card so that it projects an inch to one side of the pack. Drop entire pack from about a foot over your table. The top card will flip over face up, due to the draft hitting the projecting edge of

the card.

#29

ANY CARD OP ANY SUIT

In advance of your performance, take an entire suit - say, the hearts - out of your deck. Put them in order from ace to king, reverse the packet, put it back on the top of your deck and put the deck in its case. When you start to perform, say that you have an affinity for hearts and you would like to prove it.

Take the deck out of its case and riffle shuffle once. Put the deck behind your back and ask someone to call any card of the heart suit. As you patter and while you wait for the selection, strip out the entire suit (it will still be in order) and put the packet on top of the deck. It is, of course, an easy matter for you to count down to whatever card is called for and thus prove you are "in tune" with the hearts.

Depending on your memory - and ability - you may repeat with one or two other cards. But don't do more than three. One could be an accident, two might be coincidence, three is incontrovertible proof, four is boredom.

#30

USING A CONFEDERATE

Many apparent card miracles can be accomplished with the use of an assistant for, if you have a confederate to handle the deck while you are out of the room, you can do the seemingly impossible. You can be absent, your confederate can have a card selected and reverse the deck. You can then enter the room and find the selected card. It is important that no one knows you are working with an assistant. Brief someone in the audience as to what to do is handling the deck. Do not overdo the use of the assistant.

#31

ACE THE HARD WAY

Reverse an ace in the deck. Have the deck shuffled and then laid on the table, face down. Place a silk over the deck and cut through the silk to show the ace.

#32

A GAG BIT

This is a comedy bit that always gets a good laugh. Occasionally strip not the selected card while you are shuffling and say, "Please don't forget your card while I am shuffling." Show the card, put it back in the deck and go on with whatever effect you had planned.

#33

WHICH POCKET?

Have a card selected and reverse it in the deck. Shuffle. Ask a spectator to empty both left and right jacket pockets. Drop the deck in his left jacket pocket making sure that the edge with the protruding card is up. Bring out half the deck and place it in the spectator's right jacket pocket, making sure the reversed card remains in the *left* pocket. Now ask the spectator to name a pocket, right or left... If he says "right," tell him to discard the portion of the deck in his right pocket and you reach into the left and remove selected card.

#34

IN TRIPLICATE

Have a card selected. Ask a spectator to write his initials on the back of the card. Reverse the deck and insert the card. Shuffle the deck, bring the selected card to the bottom and quickly turn the deck face down in your right hand. Hold the deck with four fingers curled over one side and the thumb over the other. See illustration. The fingers pull back the bottom (initialed) card. Ask the spectator what his name is. As you spell out his name, keep holding back the bottom card. You always pull out one card *above* this card. When you come to the last letter of his name; pull out the card you have been holding back, turn it over and show it is the one initialed by the spectator.



#35

LUCKY THIRTEEN

Beforehand have all the spades reversed in the lower portion of the deck. Have a card selected from the top portion of the deck, reverse the deck and have the selected card inserted. Remark to the spectators that you have a lucky suit: spades and you also have a lucky numbers: thirteen. Shuffle the deck, place it behind your back and tell the audience you are going to use your lucky suit and also the lucky number to find the selected card. Come forward with all of the stripped cards face down. Count them onto the table, face down. There will be fourteen cards. Turn them over and spread them out. Spectator will see the thirteen spades and the card he selected.

#36

TWO BLACK ACES

This trick consist of a simple setup of the top eighteen cards in the deck. Deck face down, the setup is as follows: top card, any "six"; next, any five indifferent cards; then, a black ace; next, any "ten"; then, nine indifferent cards, and the other black ace. These top eighteen cards are reversed. Tell the spectators that you will locate the two black aces in an unusual manner.

Remove the pack from the case, riffle shuffle once, face down, and strip the eighteen cards to the top of the deck. Show the top card, the "six." Count down to the sixth card and turn it over. It will be the first ace. Show the next card, the "ten." Count down to the tenth card, turn it over and show it to be the second black ace.

#37

LUCKY SEVEN

Have the deck *in your pocket* with the seven of spades reversed. Talk about seven being a mystic number in magic. Remark again that spades are your lucky soil and take cards *out of your pocket one at a time*, a card for each letter. As you withdraw the cards, spell note "*S-e-v-e-n o-f S-p-a-d-e-s*" show that the last card removed from the pocket is the Seven of Spades. Place this face down on the cards already on the table. Take the remainder of the pack out of your pocket and place it to one side. Pick up the "spelled out" cards and shuffle them, face down. The Seven of Spades is still reversed. Place this small packet in your pocket. Once again spell out "Seven of Spades." Again, the last card removed is the Seven of Spades. Turn it face up as you take it out of your pocket.

#38

KINGS AND QUEENS

In advance, put the four kings on top of the deck. To begin your performance, remove the four queens and reverse the deck. Patter about the four ladies who wanted escorts for a dance and visited an escort bureau (the deck). Insert the queens haphazardly into the deck and riffle shuffle thoroughly but making sure that the four kings remain at the top. Strip the queens to the top of the deck. Remove the top eight cards (the kings and queens) and square them up. Hold the packet face down in one hand, thumb bent under one long edge, the four fingers curled under the other edge. Now, with the thump of the other hand on top and the fingers beneath, pull out together one card from the top and one from the bottom of the packet and place both cards -still together- face down on your table. Do this three times leaving two or three inches of space between pairs. When you have only two cards left in your hand, turn them over showing that at least *one* lady found an escort. Pattering on, turn the cards on the table over -one pair at a time-and remark that *all* the ladies had been lucky and were now recommending the escort bureau to all their friends. If you have followed the directions correctly, you should have the four queens paired up with the kings.

#39

THE LOST ACE

State that the aces have an affinity for each other-which you will prove. Run through the deck, remove the four aces and place them face up on your

table. Ask a spectator to choose any one of the aces and insert it back into the deck (which - as you patter - you have reversed). Shuffle. Tell the spectator that the other three aces are going to find the lost one. Pick up the three tabled aces, insert them in the deck and shuffle. Now strip the four aces to the top, cut the deck and complete the cut. Spread the deck face up and show the four aces are together.

#40

THE EYES HAVE IT

Have a card selected and put back into the reversed deck. Shuffle the deck and, if possible, control the reversed card to eighth or tenth from the top. However, it is not absolutely essential that the selected card be near the top; but the effect will be more of a "quickie" if the selected card is in the uppermost portion of the deck. Hold the deck face down in your right hand, with the protruding edge of reversed card *forward*. The right thumb and middle finger tips gently touching both forward sides of the deck and feeling the protruding, selected card. Tell the spectators that their eyes will give them away on this one. Remove the top card from the face-down pack and hold it face towards the spectators. Tell them not to give any sign when they see their card. Remove cards from the top of the deck, one at a time. Your right thumb and middle finger tips will tell you when you are showing the selected card. Stop there, look intently at the spectators' eyes (as you have been doing with all previously shown cards), then declare that they *did* give themselves away and the card you are now holding is the selected card.

#41

FINGERPRINTS

Fan the deck and have a red card selected. Reverse the deck and have the red card replaced. Ask the spectator to pick a *black* card and reverse the deck again before the card is replaced. Now, shuffle the deck, give it to him, and tell him to remove one of the two selected cards, either the black or the red. He is to do this with his back towards you. Take the deck back, strip the one reversed card to the top. Fan the deck face towards you and talk about looking for fingerprints. Naturally, you will see the color of the top card. You then name the color he removed, the opposite color to the top card.

#42

FACE UP OR FACE DOWN

Have a card selected. Reverse the pack and have the card returned to the pack. Hold the deck behind your back, remove the selected card and replace it in the deck, but *turned over*. Ask the spectator if he would like his card face up or face down. If he says, "face up," bring the deck forward and spread it on the table with all the cards face *down*. If he says he wants the selected card face

down, spread the deck face *up*. Either way his selection shows up immediately as you have turned the selected card with its face in the opposite direction to the rest of the deck.

#43
MATHEMAGICAL

Reverse any twenty cards in the deck. Shuffle. Strip the twenty to the top of the deck. Hand the deck, face down, to a spectator and ask him to count off as many cards as he wishes, up to 20, and put them in his pocket. Shuffle the deck again, place it behind your back and strip out the remaining reversed cards. Count these cards behind your back, subtract the number thus obtained from twenty. Announce the result. It *should* be the number of cards the spectator has in his pocket.

#44
COLOR TELEPATHY

In advance, separate the red and black cards, reverse all the cards of one color and shuffle the entire deck together. Place the deck in its case. To perform, remove the deck from the case and have it thoroughly shuffled. Then, quickly, strip the whole deck so that you have the top half entirely one color and the bottom half the other. Hold the deck face down and spread out the *top* half of the deck for two cards to be selected. Riffle the deck and ask that the two cards be returned, but make once the two cards are placed in the *bottom* half of the deck. Break the deck at the reversed cards, hand one half of the deck to a spectator to shuffle. You shuffle the other half. If the cards are red, they will be in the black part of the deck. After both halves have been shuffled, place them together, fan the deck face toward you, and look over the cards. Ask the spectator to concentrate on the two cards he selected. You will be able to locate them because they are the opposite color of the cards on each side of them. Do this effect slowly to give the impression of great concentration on your part.

#45
PURELY MENTAL

This mental effect with the stripper is a stunner. It is easy in execution and baffling to the layman. Have the top three cards reversed on top of the face-down deck. Let us say that they are the King of Hearts, the Ace of Clubs, and the Three of Diamonds. Display the top three cards fanned in your hand and ask a spectator to concentrate on one of them. Do not disturb their order which we will presume to be: king, ace, three. When a card has been mentally selected, place the three cards back on top of the face-down deck and give the deck one thorough riffle shuffle. Place the deck behind your back, strip out the three cards together and replace them on top of the deck. You will still have the king, ace and three in that order. Put the top card (the king) in your rear trouser

pocket, the next card (the ace) on the bottom of the deck and, the remaining card (the three), on top of the deck. Bring the deck forward and place it face down on your table. Ask the spectator to name his thought-of card. If he names the king, slowly turn around and have him remove the card from your pocket. If he names the ace, simply turn over the deck on the table or, better still: have *him* turn it over. The ace will be revealed on the bottom of the deck. If he mentions the three as the thought-of card, tell him to turn over the top card of the pack on the table. Put a little presentation into this and it can be built up into a strong mental effect. The spectator will never be aware of the fact that whichever of the three cards he names is of no importance: You have arranged a place for each card and so there are three places where the thought-of card *could* be!

#46

AN UNUSUAL VANISH

Have card selected and reverse the deck. Have the selected card returned to the deck. While shuffling, bring the selected card to the top of the deck. Place the deck face down on the table. While talking or by use of some misdirection, moisten the back of your right hand with your lips or tongue. Tell the spectator you are going to show how to make a card vanish. Place your right hand back down, on top of the top card of the pack. Do this to illustrate to the spectator what is you want him to do. When you take your hand away from the pack, the top (selected) card should be sticking to it due to the moisture on its back. Get that hand below table level quickly. The spectator will duplicate your actions. Then request that he look through the deck for his card. It will be gone! By then you will have had ample time to get the card into your pocket or wherever you want it to appear.

#47

THE TRIPLE COINCIDENCE

In advance, reverse the Ace of Spades on top of the facedown deck. Tell the spectators you are going to conduct an experiment in coincidence. A triple coincidence. Instruct one of them to count off -without looking at them- any number of cards between eight and twenty *after you leave the room*. He is to deal off the cards face down on the table. Tell him, also, that the Ace of Spades is going to play an important part in the triple coincidence. He is to pick up the packet of cards he dealt off and replace it, face down, on the face-down deck, remembering the number of cards he counted. On your return, take the deck and break off the top portion (at the reversed ace, naturally!) behind your back. This will give you the amount of cards dealt out. Now, take the reversed ace and insert it back into the same packet, but with face in the direction opposite to the rest of the cards. Bring this small packet forward and ask how many cards were counted. Show that the packet you are holding out has the same amount. Coincidence #2: The ace you mentioned is in this packet. Coincidence #3: The ace is face up, the rest of the cards face down.

#48
THE MAD MAGICIAN

Pre-arrange your deck with all the red cards reversed. Spread it, face up, on the table but do not comment on color. Just mention that the deck has been thoroughly shuffled.

Pick up the cards and strip them so the top half of the deck is black and the lower half, red.

Relate the following story:

"Once upon a time there was a madman who thought hr was a magician - or a magician who thought he was a madman ... I don't remember which. However, let's just say that all magicians are mad... or all madmen are magicians. Anyhow, the reason he was driven mad was that every time he took a card from the deck it was a red card." Remove and show a card from the bottom half of the deck you are holding face down. Replace the card.

"Even when hr cut the deck hr always got a red card." Cut the deck into the red half. "He even took a card from behind his back and, sure enough, it was a red card!" Place the deck behind your back and take a card from the lower (red) half.

"Our magician tried putting the cards in his pocket and -guess what?... Sure enough, he could only pull out a red card! It even became contagious... When his friends touched one of his cards it turned red!" Have someone touch the back of a (red) card and then show it.*

"Finally, in desperation, our mad magician decided there was only one thing to do..." Shuffle the deck and strip it once more so you again have all black on top and all reds on the bottom. "...He was not so dumb. He cleverly deduced that if he separated half the pack and touched it it would be all red ..." Divide the deck into two piles and place them widely separated on the table. "...and sure enough, all red..." Spread the red half face up on the table. "Our no-longer-mad magician finally found a way to get a black card - just turn over the other half of the deck." Turn over the second half of your deck and show it consists of all black cards.

**An excellent gag here is to have a red King of Spades ~obtainable from your magic dealer- in your pocket, ready to be handed out to be touched.*

#49
THE ALLOWANCE

"Once upon a time, a magician had a stupid wife-in fact, *any* woman who would marry a magician is stupid. However, that's beside the point. He had her believing that playing cards were money and he always gave her an allowance of 65 cents a week. Here is how he did it." The magician throws a bunch of cards on the table, they are turned face up and the total of the spots equals 65.

Method: Reverse two tens, three fives, one four, two sixes, one trey, one deuce, one eight and one ace. Strip them out and throw them on the table face down.

#50
THE STRANGER

In this effect one of the cards in your deck is of the opposite color; let us say you have a blue-backed card in a red-backed deck. Reversed, of course.

Spread the deck face down and remark that someone made a mistake in packing the deck. properties. Now, using the stripper principle you can cut to this "stranger" card, or find it behind your back, do the stabbed deck trick with the knife blade finding the odd card, etc.

For a finish, drop the deck into your coat pocket and bring out a deck of blue-backed cards into which you have inserted the reversed red-back duplicate of the one you've been using. Bring the deck out face up and spread it on the table. Patter a bit about the mysteries of color and spread the deck face down to show the stranger card has turned color and so has the rest of the pack.

#51
THE RELUCTANT CARDS

EFFECT: Three cards are selected, replaced in the deck and the deck shuffled thoroughly. Performer takes the deck and drops it into the open end of a wooden case. The selected card refuse to drop in with the others.

You will need a case to hold your deck but tapered just as the cards are. It can be easily constructed from heavy cardboard or cigar-box wood. The broad end of the case is left open. When dropping the shuffled deck back into the case, be sure to do so with *the tapered end down*. The selected cards will be forced up by the tapering of the case. Patter about how some cards are reluctant to mingle with the others.

#52
WORLD'S FASTEST COUNT

Set up your stripper deck as follows:

About ten cards from the top of the deck, reverse the next six. About ten cards from the bottom of the deck, reverse the next ten. So you will have a deck with top cards normal, six reversed, more normal cards and then ten reversed.

Place a joker between the 27th and the 28th cards and the other joker somewhere near the top or bottom of the deck.

When about to perform take the deck out of its case and, saying that you won't use the jokers for this effect, take them out and lay them on the table. However, it is important that you hold the place where the joker was marking off the 27th and the 28th cards. Break the deck at that point, hand the top half

(containing 27 cards, 6 of which are reversed) to one spectator and the bottom half (with 25 cards, 10 reversed) to another. Ask each to shuffle their half thoroughly.

Now, take the half which was originally at the top and put it behind your back. Immediately, bring your hands forward each holding a pile and say: "I have 21 cards in one hand and six in the other." Then, take the second half of the deck and repeat the same procedure but - with this half - say: "I have 15 cards in one hand and ten in the other."

When the four piles are counted, it will appear as if you have done a lightning count behind your back.

#54

JUST FOR LAUGHS

Have a Fortune Telling Deck stripped. Reverse the cards you wish to jibe with a fortune you will predict for someone. Ask someone to shuffle the deck for you. Take it back and bring the reversed cards to the top. Turn them over and show that the fortune you have predicted in advance, by reading (?) the spectator's palm, is confirmed by the cards.

#53

SUPER STRIPPER

Take two stripper decks, one blue-backed and one red-backed. From these two decks you can make two unusual decks - with infinite possibilities. Make two strippers that consist of half red-backed and half blue-backed cards. Not only can you use this as a regular stripper deck, you can now do effects involving color. For example: Separating red-backed from blue-backed cards by reversing one color; cutting to a desired color back with the deck face down on the table (selected color reversed), etc.

END STRIPPERS

You can purchase cards stripped at the ends instead of the sides of the deck. These, too, have many uses and will fool even the fellow who is familiar with the Stripper principle. However, many more effects are possible with side strippers than with end strippers, so this book is devoted solely to the side stripper.

BLANK STRIPPER

Have your favorite magic dealer strip a deck of blank cards for you. With this deck, you can do amazing "living and dead" tests and many other "mentor" routines.

MAKING YOUR OWN

Clamp an ordinary deck in a vise and, with fine sandpaper, you can wear away one corner of the entire deck. However, professionally stripped decks are

so easily and economically available from any magic shop that it is impractical to go to that much trouble.

ALPHABET CARDS

Many effects are possible with a stripped deck of Alphabet Cards. You may purchase these cards from any magic dealer and he will also strip them for you.

ESP CARDS

A deck of Extra Sensory Perception cards has symbols, instead of suits and numbers, on the faces. These symbols are Triangles, Squares, Circles etc., such as are used in telepathy experiments. A stripped deck of such symbols offers many possibilities for pseudo mind reading effects.

FOR THE CARD MEN

For those with a good working knowledge of sleight of hand the stripper can prove invaluable in many effects. Those listed below are a few you can use in conjunction with standard effects.

#55

TAP IT OFF

This is a weird effect. Have two cards reversed in the deck. Shuffle and bring them to the top. Hold the deck face down in your left hand. With your right thumb and middle finger, lightly pick up the two top cards by the protruding edges and show the two cards as one card. Replace the two cards on top of the deck. Ask a spectator to tap the back of the top card on the pack. Show it. Because he presumed that he tapped the card which was shown him, he will be amazed when you turn the card over and it proves to have changed to a different one.



#56

THE AUTOMATIC RISE

As in the previous effect reverse two cards, strip them and bring them to the top. With your right thumb and middle finger show the two top cards as one. Place the double back on top of the deck. Hold the deck face down and bury the top card in the deck. Tap the top of the deck and show that the card you "buried" has returned to the top.

#57

THE PAPER CLIP

Have two cards reversed in the deck. Shuffle. Strip the two reversed cards to the top and show as one card. Replace the two cards on top of the deck and fasten a paper clip to the top card. The spectator will presume that the clip is on the card you showed him. Lay the three top cards face down on the table and tell the spectator to name the card with the clip on it. Of course, he won't!

#58

THE FLYING CARD

Reverse two aces in the deck. Let us use the Ace of Spades and the Ace of

Diamonds for illustration. Shuffle the deck and strip the two aces to the top. Grasp the protruding edges of the reversed cards and show the double card as one card. Let us say the spectators see the Ace of Spades (the Ace of Diamonds is hidden behind it). Place the two cards back on top of the deck, remove the face-down top card and lay it on the table. The spectator will presume this card to be the Ace of Spades. Remove the second ace from the top of the deck and hold it face down over the card on the table. The ace in your hand (Ace of Spades) is held about a foot over the face-down card on the table. Tap the back of the facedown card in your hand and show it to be the Ace of Spades, turn over the card on the table and show it to be the Ace of Diamonds.

#59

ONE HAND LOCATION

Request that a card be selected. Reverse the deck, ask that the card be replaced and then that the deck be shuffled. Remarking that, "The hand is quicker than the eye," show that the selected card is not on the bottom nor on the top of the deck. Hold the deck in the right hand in position for the one hand cut. When your right thumb feels the reversed card, allow the cards below it to fall into your right palm; complete the cut, then show that the selected card is on the bottom of the deck.

#60

THE BAD PENNY

Reverse three aces in the deck and shuffle. Strip the aces to the top. Execute a triple lift (showing the three cards as one). Let us say that when you show the spectators the (apparently one) card, they see the Ace of Hearts. Remark that the Ace of Hearts is a bad penny and always keeps turning up. Lay the three cards face down on top of the deck. Remove the top card and place it in the center of the deck, face down. The spectators will presume that you have buried the Ace of Hearts. Now, do a double lift with the two cards on top of the deck and show that the Ace of Hearts has returned to the top. Place the two cards face down on top of the deck and, again, bury the top card. Once again show the top card, The Ace of Hearts is back! Throw up your hands in disgust and remark you give up.

#61

THREE CARD MONTE

A good sucker effect., Have two cards previously reversed in the deck. Shuffle and bring them to the top. Lift the two cards as in effect #55, and show to the spectators. Place the two cards back on top of the deck, then bend back the corner of the top card and place it face down on the table. The spectators will presume that the card with the bent corner is the same one you have shown. Lay two more cards face down alongside the bent one. *Do not show the*

faces. Move the three cards around. Ask the spectator to pick out the card first shown him, he will of course turn over - the card with bent corner.

#62
PASSE PASSE

Proceed exactly as in effect #58 (Flying Card) until after you show the double card and replace the two on top of the deck. Then openly take the top card and place it face unseen, in a spectator's pocket. The ace left on top of the deck is shuffled into the deck. Now, "command" the two aces to change places. The spectator will find that the ace in his pocket is the one he presumed to be in the deck and the one in the deck the ace he thought you had given him.

#63
INKREDIBLE

Prepare an ordinary, *unstripped*, Ace of Hearts by putting a drop of blue ink near the center of the large pip and allow it to dry. Insert this prepared ace in your stripper.

Force the unprepared, *stripped*, Ace of Hearts from your stripper on a spectator; or, cut to it and show it to your audience but don't look at it yourself. Shuffle the deck and palm out this tapered ace (leaving, of course, the prepared unprepared ace in the pack). Insert the deck face down into its case.

Patter about magicians' blood having magical properties and-as every magician has magic in his veins- his blood can locate the desired card.

From your pocket, take out a fountain pen which you have filled with vanishing ink* and remark that this effect requires blood, blue magicians' blond and you have filled the pen with your own. Let one drop of ink fall on the outside of the card-case, near the center. With your forefinger, gently rub the drop of ink. It will vanish completely in a second or two. Remove the deck from the case, spread it face up and show the selected card has an ink spot on it.

**This ink is sold at most novelty and magic shops.*

#64
THE JACKS' PERSISTENCY
(Originally published in Hugard's MAGIC Monthly)

EFFECT: Magician ribbonspreads a deck of cards, faces up, and slides the four jacks clear of the spread. Leaving the jacks face up on the table, he gathers up the deck, squares it and invites any spectator to shuffle it. Taking the deck back he asks four different spectators each to insert one of the jacks at any point they please in the deck. When this has been done, performer again requests someone to shuffle the cards thoroughly. Performer then takes the deck and makes it into four separate piles on the table before him. When top card of each pile is turned over, spectators are surprised to find that all the

jacks have risen to the top.

METHOD: When deck is returned, riffle shuffle once, strip the jacks to the top and riffle shuffle once more retaining the jacks in position.

Now:

1. Hold deck in your left hand, right edge parallel to floor and resting on the lower joints of middle, ring and little fingers with thumb lying across left edge and forefinger curled against face of bottom card.

2. With tip of left thumb, riffle upper left corner of deck until you have about $\frac{1}{4}$ of the deck left to go.

3. Grasp the top $\frac{3}{4}$ portion of the deck between your right thumb at the inner end and your fingers at the outer end and lift packet clear of bottom portion. *At the same time*, left middle, ring and little fingers curl up and press against top card (jack) retaining it against top of bottom packet remaining in left hand.

4. Place this packet on the table and repeat steps 2 and 3 until you have four packets on the table each with a jack on top.

SUGGESTED PRESENTATION AND PATTERN: Idly shuffling your deck, ask: "Have any of you ever noticed how some decks have cards which are really obnoxious?.., No matter where you put them, they keep turning up!... I'll show you what I mean - .. In this particular deck, the jacks are the social climbers. Let's take them out.,," (Ribbonspread the deck and slide jacks out; pick up the spread, square it up, shuffle.)

..Some of you may think that the jacks turn up only for me... that they have an 'affinity' for me.., Well I'll ask four of you gentlemen to pick up one jack each and insert it wherever you like in the deck... Now, sir, will you please shuffle the deck? Thank you... While our cooperative friend makes sure that the jacks are really buried, let's review what has happened..." (Use index fingers of right hand to count off left fingers thus casually showing your hands are clean.)

One, we separated the jacks from the rest of the cards and left them face up on the table in order to make certain that they were not in some sort of pre-arranged sequence. Two, four different persons replaced a jack at a different spot in the deck. Three, another person is now shuffling the deck - .. Will you, sir," (to the shuffler) "please make sure that there are no jacks at the top or bottom of the deck and then give it back to me? Thank you--- Let us now square the deck.,, divide it into four parts ... like so.... and now... we turn over the top card of each pile ...and... we find... that you can't keep the jacks down. No matter *where* you put them, they persist in climbing to the top!"

WARNING: Don't let more than one spectator at a time pick up a jack and keep your eyes on him! He may inadvertently turn his jack end for end.

#65

ELUSIVE CARD

An elusive card routine is always entertaining and mystifying. However,

by having a card previously reversed in the deck you can add a great deal to the effect, for during the routine you can have a spectator shuffle the cards and immediately go into the elusive card again.

#66

If a card is protruding at end "a" of the deck, that same card will be indented at end "b" of the deck. This indentation may be used as a short card. There is a definite click when the deck is riffled at this end.

#67

Use the reversed card as a "key" card. You can cut to the reversed card easily after each shuffle and have the selected card placed next to it.

#68

Card on ceiling, using the stripper to bring the selected card to position.

#69

If you do "Out Of This World" - and you probably do - using the stripper makes it all the more of a miracle. Simply have the cards set up its the case with one color reversed, hand the deck to the spectator to be shuffled, quickly separate site colors and you are set to perform.

#70

For a gambling routine you can have site desired cards reversed, then shuffle, and bring the entire setup to site top of the deck.

#71

Needless to say, bringing a card to the top for palming is an easy matter with the stripper. After site card is palmed and the deck shuffled you can add the palmed card to the deck, still reversed, and be able to do many unusual effects.

#72

You will find that, with a little experimentation, the stripper can be very useful in your work. For example: without any false shuffles or passes you can force the same card several times, simply by bringing the stripped card you are forcing to the top of the deck.

#73

THE GIANT FAN

If every other card in the deck is reversed, it is an easy matter to get into position for the giant fan without interweaving the two halves of the deck. Simply strip out half the cards almost to their full length, giving the pack nearly double the length and then go right into the fan, The stripping should be done quickly and smoothly.

The two effects which follow were devised by my good friend, John V, Hope. A past president of New York's F.A.M.E., Mr. Hope is a versatile magician with a particular bent for coin magic. However, the following samples will prove that he is no "slouch" with cards!

#74

BOOKED DECK DISCOVERY

EFFECT: A card is selected and returned to the deck. During the shuffle, some cards become reversed in the deck. On spreading the cards it is seen that the deck is pretty well mixed up with cards face up and face down. The deck is shuffled some more and cut once. Spreading the cards again it is seen that they have all righted themselves, except for the selected card.

METHOD: Have a card selected and returned as you usually do for controlling the card. Start shuffling and, after one or two regular shuffles, reverse *one half* the deck and turn it face up. Continue shuffling. This will give you what gamblers call a "booked" deck, that is: a deck with the cards mixes face up and face down. This turning of the cards face up is important. The simplest way is to open the deck like a book, using one of the ends as an imaginary hinge. Continue opening this imaginary book until both packets touch the table. You now have one packet face up and one face down. Without changing the relationship of the packets, shuffle them into each other. Show the cards to be all messed up.

After showing the cards to be hopelessly mixed, strip out all projecting cards and place them on top of the deck. When all the projecting cards are on top of the deck, turn these cards over so that both packets are facing the same way. Spread the cards and all of them will be facing the same way except the selected card.

NOTE: If the deck has been used a bit, spread it outface up. There is a tendency for the reversed card to stick to the others and not show itself. If this happens, don't say anything about the selected card. Square the deck and make a magical gesture towards it. Now, spread the cards face down and the selected card will be the only one face up.

#75

AGAIN THE BOOKED DECK

EFFECT: The deck is shuffled with about half the cards face up and half face down. Spreading the cards in your hands, explain to a spectator: "Run through the cards as I'm doing and if you see a card you don't like, turn it face down, if you see a card that is face down and you want to know what card it is, turn it face up. Remember which cards you turn either face up or face down." After the spectator has done this, take the deck from him, shuffle it and cut it a few times. Spread the deck and show that all the cards have righted themselves, except the cards reversed by the spectator.

METHOD: Shuffle about half the deck face up into the other face-down half as explained in the previous effect. Explain to the spectator, what you want him to do, illustrating with the cards in your hands. When turning cards face up or face down, do so with a right to left or vice versa motion. *Do not reverse them by turning the cards over end for end.* Return any cards that you reverse to their original position, impress upon your spectator that you want him to turn his cards over as you did, then hand him the deck. After he has reversed his selected cards, take the deck from him and shuffle a bit. Strip all the face up or face down cards to the top of the pack. By reversing or turning this packet so that the cards in it are facing in the same direction as the faces of the other packet, you have arranged the deck so that *all* the cards have righted themselves *except the spectator's cards*.

A SHORT STRIPPER ROUTINE

A routine, or "act" with the stripper should not be of long duration, for even good card tricks can become boring. If you use this routine, practice it over and over again. Know the sequence of the tricks so well that you almost automatically go from one effect to the next. Most important of all: Be sure you

know how to "handle" the stripper properly so that it is not apparent that you are using a trick deck. When seated with a group of spectators start out by having the deck shuffled by several persons. Watch for the one who shuffles the deck properly, i.e.: no reversals as he shuffles. When you have noticed those that shuffle "your" way, pick on *them* when the effect you want to present requires that the deck be shuffled by a spectator.

PATTER & ROUTINE

"Ladies and Gentlemen: The secret of card manipulation is control. By *control* I mean the shuffling of the deck and apparently losing of the selected card or cards during the shuffle when actually the performer has control of the selected cards whenever he wishes. I would like to give you some examples of card control. First, the simplest: control of a single card."

Have a card selected, reverse the deck, have card inserted in the deck and then located quickly by you.

"Now, for a multiple control. We shall have four persons select a card and endeavor to locate all four of them."

Have four cards selected and inserted in the reversed deck. Shuffle and find the four cards, preferably by bringing them to the top.

"Now I wish to show you two of the most difficult types of card location."

Find two selected cards, one behind your back, the other under a silk.

"Now, here is an example of a spectator unwittingly controlling his own card."

Perform "The Coincidence" (#1).

"And now for the impossible! The most unusual card trick you have ever seen...and don't try to figure it out-it is impossible."

Finish up by performing "The Indian Giver" (#10).

It is wise to learn a few simple card tricks that you can do without using the stripper principle. Your magic dealer has a vast number of books on simple card tricks and sleight of hand. It is also a good idea to have in your pocket, an ordinary deck of cards, with backs to match the stripper you are using. When finished with the stripper routine, drop the trick deck into your pocket then, as an afterthought, bring out the ordinary deck and show a few simple card tricks. This is the easiest of "switches."

